

Inclusive Teaching Framework

A practical framework for reviewing curriculum, teaching and assessment.

Our vision is inclusive practice as standard practice.

The framework brings together four areas: Respect & representation, Equity of opportunity, Accessibility, and Language & literacies. Use the questions as prompts for reflection and redesign; you do not need to work through every item at once.

Respect & representation	Equity of opportunity
Whose knowledge, identities and ways of participating are treated as legitimate?	Can students with different lives, resources and responsibilities realistically participate?
Accessibility	Language & literacies
Are materials, environments and activities usable without avoidable friction?	Are expectations, disciplinary conventions and hidden rules visible and learnable?

Curriculum & program design

Respect & representation

- Whose knowledge and perspectives are represented?
- Are marginalised perspectives embedded meaningfully?
- Do learning outcomes include inclusive capabilities where relevant?

Equity of opportunity

- Do I design for common barriers?
- Is there flexibility in course structure and timelines?
- Have I reduced hidden course costs?

Accessibility

- Are my learning materials and environments accessible?
- Is it clear what content is essential?
- Have I built common accessibility adjustments in?

Language & literacies

- Do I teach the literacies students need?
- Are terminology and expectations explicit?
- Is language support built into the course?

Teaching

Respect & representation

- Are expectations for respectful participation clear?
- Do I treat students' lived experience as an asset?
- Do I address microaggressions when they arise?

Equity of opportunity

- Is help-seeking normal and visible?
- Are key materials available early?
- Do I notice disengagement and reach out early?

Accessibility

- Do I build in enough processing time?
- Do I teach in more than one mode?
- Can students participate in different ways?

Language & literacies

- Do I normalise unfamiliarity with academic language and norms?
- Are disciplinary conventions visible?
- Do I support students working in an additional language?
- Do I teach the digital literacies students need?

Assessment

Respect & representation

- Have I checked cultural assumptions and hidden norms?
- Can students demonstrate learning in different ways?
- Is feedback respectful and intellectually serious?

Equity of opportunity

- Have I built common adjustments into assessment?
- Is group work structured for equitable participation?
- Do students have chances to practise and get feedback?
- Are marking and grade-query processes clear?

Accessibility

- Can students make meaningful choices in assessment?
- Are my assessment criteria and materials accessible?
- Can students access feedback in different ways?

Language & literacies

- Are assessment instructions and criteria clear?
- Can students practise before high-stakes assessment?
- Do students see annotated examples of good work?
- Does feedback help students develop communication?

Using the framework

Start with the problem you are seeing. A high number of adjustment requests, unclear assessment expectations, low participation, hidden costs or narrow representation can all be useful entry points. Follow the relevant question, make one practical change, then review what difference it makes for participation and learning.

The framework is intended to support reflective practice and course redesign. Some barriers sit beyond the control of an individual teacher and may require changes to workload, staffing, policy, timetabling, systems, spaces, leadership or resourcing.